```
UNLIKE other airline Frequent Flyer programs,
OUR PRODUCT lets members use their points easily for any sort of online or
     brick-and-mortar purchase.
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This short text sums up who your target audience is, what they want, how your product will give it to them, and how your product distinguishes itself from its competitors. Of course, there's no obligation to follow this (or any other) template to the letter, but it does provide a good summary of the sort of things that you should consider including in your vision statement.

Writing a viable vision statement can be a tricky exercise, but it pays off over the life of the project. One effective approach to writing a good vision statement is to think in terms of designing a product flyer. In a nutshell, what does your product do? How will the product benefit your organization? Who is your target audience, and why would they buy your product rather than that of a competitor? What are its three or four principal selling points? Discuss these questions with all of the key project players, including users, stakeholders, and the development team. Then try to formulate a vision statement using Moore's template. If your project team is big enough, you can split up into several cross-functional groups and compare results, refining the statement until everyone agrees.

EXERCISE 3.2 Write a vision statement for the bus subsidies project from the previous exercise using Moore's template. How does it compare with what you wrote at the start of this section?

3.4 How will it benefit the business? Identify the business goals

Once you have a clear idea of the project vision, you need to define the underlying business goals that drive the project and contribute to realizing this vision. A business goal succinctly defines how the project will benefit the organization or how it will align with the organization's strategies or vocation.

All projects have business goals; otherwise management wouldn't have approved them in the first place. But not all projects have clearly defined and visible business goals. And projects with well-defined and well-communicated business goals have a much better chance of success than those that don't. A recent university study found that teams with a clear common understanding of their goal cooperated better and worked more effectively.[5]

Understanding these goals is even more important when unforeseen issues arise, when technical challenges make implementing a particular solution harder than initially thought, or when the team realizes they've misunderstood the requirements and need to do things differently. If developers are expected to respond appropriately to

[5] Panagiotis Mitkidis et al., "Collective-Goal Ascription Increases Cooperation in Humans," PLOS ONE (May 2013) 8:5, http://www.plosone.org/article/info%3Adoi%2F10.1371%2Fjournal.pone.0064776.